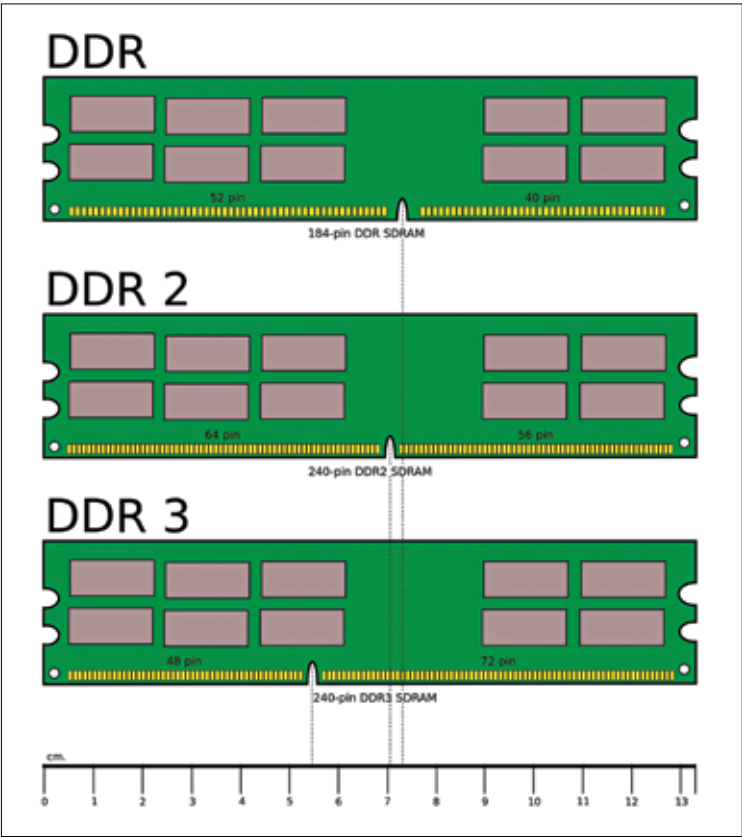


Hub or MCH for short) and the Southbridge (I/O Hub or IOH for short). However, these two have been since merged into the PCH or Platform Controller Hub. Or you can just call it a chipset, a more generic term that gets the message across. This chipset decides which all I/O ports exist and what speeds they operate at. It acts as an intermediary between I/O ports and the CPU.

Housing the CPU and RAM: CPU is the single most important component of the system and affects the motherboard's design in a significant way. Like all other components, the CPU goes in its own slot. In case of motherboards built for use by servers, there can be more than one CPU slots but for sake of simplicity and the lack of availability in normal mar-



The cut in the RAM module does not allow it to be used with an incompatible board